

MAHLATSE SARAH MOLEPO

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Final-year BSc Information Technology student with hands-on experience in software development, mobile and web application development, database systems, and web application security testing. Able to design and build user-focused solutions across cybersecurity, fintech, and education projects using C#, Java, JavaScript, SQL, HTML, and CSS. Holds Cisco certifications in Data Analytics and Cybersecurity, and completed a hands-on penetration testing capstone through MWR CyberSec. Placed 2nd at an internal university hackathon. Looking to join a graduate programme and contribute strong technical skills, a security-aware mindset, and a passion for building useful technology.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology

Expected: December 2026

North-West University

Relevant coursework: C++, Python, C#, Databases, Systems Analysis and Design, Artificial Intelligence, Decision Support Systems

CERTIFICATIONS

- Data Analytics Essentials, Cisco (2025)
- Introduction to Cybersecurity, Cisco (2025)
- MWR CyberSec Virtual Internship: Web Application Penetration Testing, Certificate of Completion (2026)

PROJECTS

MWR CyberSec Capstone – Web Application Penetration Test

2026

Independent security project, MWR CyberSec Virtual Internship

- Carried out a full web application penetration test against a TryHackMe-hosted target as the final capstone task
- Found and exploited a Stored Cross-Site Scripting (XSS) vulnerability and an unrestricted file upload flaw that led to remote code execution (RCE)
- Wrote a professional penetration test report explaining each vulnerability, how it was found, and how to fix it
- Shared the outcome and lessons learned in a LinkedIn post to build a public record of the work

SecureScan – Cybersecurity Website and URL Analysis Tool

JavaScript, HTML, CSS

A cybersecurity web application that lets users scan and check websites and URLs for possible threats. Built to copy real-world threat detection steps, showing risk information in a simple, easy-to-read interface.

- Built the full frontend using JavaScript, HTML, and CSS, focused on a responsive layout and real-time interaction
- Set up URL input handling and result display to show threat analysis feedback to users
- Used cybersecurity concepts from Cisco training to guide the app's security-focused design
- Organised the code using clean code principles for easier maintenance and future growth

MoneyMind – Budget and Expense Tracking Mobile App

C#, SQLite, Android

A mobile app built to help people manage their personal finances by tracking income, expenses, and budgets. Developed as part of a team project that followed a real software development workflow.

- Worked in a team using Git and GitHub to manage code contributions and resolve merge conflicts
- Built CRUD functionality for managing budget categories and expense records using C# and SQLite
- Designed the local database schema to store and retrieve transaction data using relational database principles
- Helped design the user interface to keep the app simple and easy to use for non-technical users

CampusConnect – Student Support Website

HTML, CSS, JavaScript

A student-focused website built to connect university students with tutors, study peers, and a campus marketplace. Built as a prototype for the NWU Geekulcha Hackathon, where it won 2nd place.

- Co-built the platform from idea to working prototype within the hackathon time limit
- Built core features including tutor search, peer matching, and a student marketplace listing page
- Presented the solution to a panel of judges, showing strong communication and technical explanation skills
- Won 2nd place at the NWU internal Geekulcha Hackathon out of multiple competing teams

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: C#, Java, SQL, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Python, C++

Software Development: OOP, CRUD Application Development, Systems Analysis and Design, UI/UX Design, Mobile and Web Development, Debugging and Testing

Databases: SQL Server, SQLite, Oracle SQL, Relational Database Design

Tools and Platforms: Git, GitHub, Visual Studio, VS Code, Android Development Tools

Cybersecurity: Web Application Penetration Testing, Vulnerability Exploitation (XSS, RCE), Web Application Attacks, OWASP Principles, SQL Injection, Linux, Secure Coding Practices

Soft Skills: Team Collaboration, Problem Solving, Communication, Adaptability, Time Management

REFERENCES

Available on request.